



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

January 13, 2026

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Fire Chief Tim Gonzales, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt the agenda. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS:

- A. Proclamation - Honoring Wanda Beavers (Mama Tu-Tu) for her lifelong service to the City of Jackson**
- B. Presentation -Rehmann, LLC, City of Jackson Audit Report for FY Ended June 30, 2025**
- C. Presentation - Bendzinski & Co., 2018 Capital Improvement Bonds Refunding**

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

A. City Housing and Community Development Needs

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to open the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Comments were received.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard.

7:56 p.m. *John C. King, 203 3rd Street*

Time was paused and a warning was issued about personal attacks being made during his comments. After refusing to adhere to the rules, his comment time was ended 36 seconds prior to the 3 minutes allotment.

8:01 p.m.

After several minutes of refusing to leave the podium to allow for the meeting to continue, and after accosting members of the public, Mayor Mahoney asked that John King be removed from the meeting. Chief Simpson escorted John King out of chambers at 8:02 p.m..

At the conclusion of citizen comments, a motion was made by Councilmember Hunt, supported by Councilmember Gunn to take a 7 minute and 6 second break. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Council recessed from 8:22 -8:30 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to return from recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes - Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on December 16, 2025

B. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Four Months Ended October 31, 2025

C. Amend the Obligation of American Rescue Plan Act funding to the City's Lead Service Line Replacement Program Project Area

Approve the amendment to the obligation of American Rescue Plan Act funding to the City's Lead Service Line Replacement Program, to replace service lines per the Safe Drinking Water Act's 2018 and 2024 revisions to the Lead and Copper Rule to include the entire City of Jackson.

D. Reappointment to the City Planning Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint James Johnson, Jr. to the City Planning Commission for a three-year term beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2028.

E. Resignation from the Human Relations Commission

Accept with regret, the resignation of Barbara Holt from the Human Relations Commission.

F. Reappointment to the Human Relations Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Miriam Brown Dorsey to the Human Relations Commission for a three-year term, beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2028, in concurrence with the HRC recommendation.

G. Reappointment to the Jackson District Library Board of Trustees

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Brenda Pilgrim to the Jackson District Library Board of Trustees for a four-year term, beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2029.

H. Appointment to the Historic District Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Sven Harrison to the Historic District Commission for a three-year term beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2028.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar. Councilmember Forgrave requested that Item G be removed for separate consideration. Vice Mayor Dancy requested that item C be removed for separate consideration. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the amendment to the obligation of American Rescue Plan Act funding to the City's Lead Service Line Replacement Program to replace service lines per the Safe Drinking Water Act's 2018 and 2024 revisions to the Lead and Copper Rule to include the entire City of Jackson. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Brenda Pilgrim to the Jackson District Library Board of Trustees for a four-year term, beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2029. Councilmember Forgrave stated he would be abstaining from the vote because of his employment status with the Jackson District Library. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Hunt (6). Nays: none. Abstention: Forgrave. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. Ordinance No. 2026-01

Recommendation: *Approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 2026-01, amending the City of Jackson Code of Ordinances to update the Fire Prevention Code.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the second reading/final adoption of Ordinance No. 2026-01, amending the City of Jackson Code of Ordinances to update the Fire Prevention Code. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. City of Jackson Purchasing Manual Revisions

Recommendation: *Approve the revisions to the City of Jackson Purchasing Manual.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the revisions to the City of Jackson Purchasing Manual. Vote - Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Resolution – Deficit Elimination Plan

Recommendation: *Approve the Deficit Elimination Plan Resolution for the Special Assessment Capital Project Fund Deficit as of June 30, 2025.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the Deficit Elimination Plan Resolution for the Special Assessment Capital Project Fund Deficit as of June 30, 2025. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Contract – 2026 As-Needed Materials Testing Services

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the 2026 As-Needed Materials Testing Services Contract to Materials Testing Consultants, Inc. of Dexter, Michigan, at a cost of \$273,435.00, and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the award of the 2026 As-Needed Materials Testing Services Contract to Materials Testing Consultants, Inc. of Dexter, Michigan, at a cost of \$273,435.00, and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Contract – Hazardous Tree Removal Program (Renewal)

Recommendation: *Approve the first renewal of the Hazardous Tree Removal Program Contract with Top Notch Tree Care, LLC of Leslie, Michigan, at a cost of \$26,574.00, and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the first renewal of the Hazardous Tree Removal Program Contract with Top Notch Tree Care, LLC of Leslie, Michigan, at a cost of \$26,574.00, and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Change Order – Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 4 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division Contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc., in the increased amount of \$14,411.12 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve Change Order 4 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division Contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc., in the increased amount of \$14,411.12 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Change Order – Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Lead Service Line Replacements

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Lead Service Line Replacements Contract with Five Star Energy Services, LLC in the increased amount of \$1,566,260 to fully utilize available DWSRF financing and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve Change Order 1 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Phase 1 Lead Service Line Replacements Contract with Five Star Energy Services, LLC in the increased amount of \$1,566,260.00 to fully utilize available DWSRF financing and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Sale of City-Owned Property to Habitat for Humanity

Recommendation: *Approve the sale of City-owned property located at 322 Clinton Street, Jackson, Michigan 49201 (Parcel #2-004800000) to the Greater Jackson Habitat for Humanity for the sum of \$300, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the sale of City-owned property located at 322 Clinton Street, Jackson, Michigan 49201 the Greater Jackson Habitat for Humanity for the sum of \$300, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Opioid/Substance Use Disorder Grant Awards

Recommendation: *Award a grant of \$275,000 to both the Home of New Vision and Welcome Home Organization to provide opioid/substance use disorder relief services for the City of Jackson, and for the City Manager and City Attorney to effectuate the grant agreement and make minor modifications if necessary.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to award a grant of \$275,000.00 to both the Home of New Vision and Welcome Home Organization to provide opioid/substance use disorder relief services for the City of Jackson, and for the City Manager and City Attorney to effectuate the grant agreement and make minor modifications if necessary. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Establishment of a Special Assessment Relief Fund

Recommendation: *Approve the establishment of a Street Assessment Relief Fund and associated fund management policy to assist property owners in paying special assessments for street construction.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the establishment of a Street Assessment Relief Fund and associated fund management policy to assist property owners in paying special assessments for street construction. Vote -Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER'S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 9:27 p.m.